

133 Build a container pond

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MINS

Ponds make great wildlife havens. Even if you only have a balcony, you have room for a mini pond. Put it in a shady spot so it won't dry out, and remember to place it in its final position before filling it with water.

What you need

- Clean bricks/gravel
- Container holding at least 10 gallons (40 liters)
- Aquatic plants
- Rainwater



1 Put the bricks in the container bottom to make a platform for the plants. Pour in the gravel. Fill two-thirds full with rainwater.



2 Add plants: oxygen-makers first, then edging plants. Leave the edging plants in pots, but add some gravel to weigh them down.



3 Fill the pond with rainwater. Put one or two floating plants on top. Add a stick bridge so any creatures that fall in can escape.

Stick reaches to edge



134 Let life begin

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Fill a jar with rainwater. After a few days, does it turn green? This means you have microscopic life in your jar. Look closely—you may also see insect larvae swimming around.

